

CREARTBOX

OPENING NIGHT

Currents

Friday, October 30, 2026 · 7:30 pm

450 W 37th St, New York

Guillermo Laporta · Johannes Brahms · Eric Moe
Clara Schumann · Robert Schumann

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NEW YORK SERIES

at The DiMenna Center for Classical Music

12th season

———— 2026 / 27 ————



TRE PEZZI · FEBRUARY 2026

Emilie-Anne Gendron, violin, and Josefina Urraca,
piano, at The DiMenna Center.

Program

GUILLERMO LAPORTA	4'
Brown Leaves Moving	
JOHANNES BRAHMS	8'
Trio in A minor, Op. 114	
I. Allegro	
viola, cello and piano	
ERIC MOE	5'
Laminar Flow in Upsidedown Creek	
CLARA SCHUMANN	11'
Three Romances, Op. 22	
violin and piano	
ROBERT SCHUMANN	28'
Piano Quartet in E-flat major, Op. 47	
violin, viola, cello and piano	
TOTAL PLAYING TIME	56'

This evening's performance lasts approximately 60 minutes and is played without intermission. Please silence all electronic devices. Flash photography is not permitted at any time.

CreArtBox's programs are made possible by the New York State Council on the Arts with the support of the Office of the Governor and the New York State Legislature, and by the NYC Department of Cultural Affairs.

PROGRAMME NOTES

Two of tonight's titles come from the physics of moving fluids. The other three works come from one circle of musicians: Joseph Joachim is the dedicatee of Clara Schumann's Romances and the violist Brahms tried out in the Op. 114 Trio, and Clara gave the first public performance of Robert's Piano Quartet.

GUILLERMO LAPORTA

2018 · 4'

Brown Leaves Moving

Written in 2018 as part of AWAVE, a suite for flute, piano and electronics, first performed in Queens that year. Tonight it is played by the full quintet, with the electronic part running underneath as background sound.

Its subject is leaves moved by the wind, and that movement is built into the performance rather than only described by it. The players begin offstage and walk slowly on as they play, so the ensemble assembles itself in front of the audience instead of waiting for it.

Laporta founded CreArtBox in New York in 2013 and has combined a flutist's career with theatre direction and lighting design; the staging of a piece is, for him, part of its writing.

Trio in A minor, Op. 114 · I. Allegro

In December 1890 Brahms told his publisher Fritz Simrock that he meant to stop composing. The String Quintet Op. 111, finished that summer, was to be the last thing he published.

In March 1891, visiting the court at Meiningen, he heard the orchestra's principal clarinetist, Richard Mühlfeld. That summer, at Bad Ischl, he wrote two works for him: this Trio and the Clarinet Quintet Op. 115. The Trio was played privately in Meiningen on 24 November 1891 and publicly at the Singakademie in Berlin on 12 December, with Mühlfeld, the cellist Robert Hausmann, and Brahms at the piano.

Simrock published it in March 1892 with a viola part offered as an alternative to the clarinet, the same provision Brahms had made for the Horn Trio Op. 40. Both scorings were rehearsed before publication, with Joachim on viola. That is the version heard tonight, first movement only.

Laminar Flow in Upsidedown Creek

Laminar flow is the term in fluid dynamics for movement in smooth parallel layers with no mixing between them, the opposite of turbulence.

Eric Moe (b. 1954, Durham, North Carolina) studied at Princeton and Berkeley, is Andrew W. Mellon Professor of Composition and Theory at the University of Pittsburgh, and co-directs the Music on the Edge new-music series there. He wrote this piece during one of his residencies at the Montana Artists Refuge in Basin, Montana. Jeanne Golan recorded a piano version of it on *It Takes One to Tango* (Steinway & Sons, 2021), a programme of works with roots in popular music, where it sits alongside Pablo Ortiz's *Three Pieces*.

The work reaches this programme through CreArtBox's open Call for Scores, which places selected composers on the season roster and gives their music a New York performance with the core ensemble.

CLARA SCHUMANN

1853 · 11'

Three Romances, Op. 22

Written in Düsseldorf in 1853, in the same run of work that produced the Variations Op. 20, the piano Romances Op. 21 and the Rollett songs Op. 23. They are dedicated to Joachim, then twenty-two and employed at the Hanoverian court; he and Clara toured them in Germany and Britain, including a performance for King George V, who by Joachim's account was enthusiastic. Breitkopf & Härtel published them in 1855.

They are among the last original works she completed. Brahms, aged twenty, arrived at the Schumanns' door on 30 September 1853; Robert collapsed the following February and entered the asylum at Endenich in March 1854. From then on Clara composed almost nothing new, giving her working life to performing and to editing Robert's music.

Three pieces, each on a single lyric idea, with the piano writing of a virtuoso writing for herself.

Piano Quartet in E-flat major, Op. 47

1842 was Schumann's chamber-music year: the three string quartets Op. 41, the Piano Quintet Op. 44, this Quartet, and the piano trio later published as *Phantasiestücke* Op. 88. The Quartet was sketched between 24 and 30 October and copied out between 7 and 26

November. It is dedicated to Count Matvei Wielhorsky, a Russian amateur cellist known to the Schumanns, which may have something to do with how much the cello is given to do. After a private reading in St Petersburg during the Schumanns' Russian tour, Clara gave the public premiere at the Leipzig Gewandhaus on 8 December 1844, with Ferdinand David on violin and Niels Gade on viola.

Of the two E-flat works the Quintet has always been the more public. The Quartet is the more inward: a scherzo running on staccato scales with two contrasting trios, and a slow movement, *Andante cantabile*, whose melody is handed first to the cello.

That slow movement ends with the cellist tuning the bottom C string down a whole step to B-flat, to hold a pedal note beneath the final bars that the instrument cannot otherwise reach. It serves the music and inconveniences the player, who has to retune mid-movement and back again for the finale.

TONIGHT'S PERFORMERS

Guillermo Laporta FLUTE · EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Guillermo Laporta is a Spanish flutist, composer, and designer based in New York City. His artistic practice brings together classical music and visual storytelling. As a composer, he has written operas and multidisciplinary works including *Architecture of a Common Man* (2023) and *Two Roads* (2019), alongside productions he defines as "visual concerts," integrating video, projection, lighting, and theatrical design into live classical music. Critics have praised his "impressive staging" (*El País*) and "unique take on classical music" (*Times Ledger*).

Laporta co-founded CreArtBox with pianist Josefina Urraca in 2013 and serves as its Executive and Co-Artistic Director. CreArtBox is a New York-based piano quintet with an established concert season, touring activity, new commissions, and a growing network of artistic and institutional partnerships. They also founded Festival ADAR in rural Asturias, presenting concerts, residencies, and site-specific installations.

Expanding the flute repertoire is a central part of Laporta's work, reimagining works by composers such as Janáček, Sibelius, Respighi, and Dvořák for the flute, while contributing new works and commissions to the contemporary flute repertoire. This work is documented across three studio albums. As a performer, he has appeared with ensembles including the BBC Orchestra and at Carnegie Hall and Lincoln Center, with recording credits on Warner Music, EMI, and Naxos.

Laporta studied at the Royal College of Music in London with flutist and conductor Jaime Martín.

Josefina Urraca PIANO · CO-DIRECTOR

Josefina Urraca is a Spanish pianist and co-director of CreArtBox and the Festival ADAR. Her playing has been praised by *Mundo Clásico* for its blend of "introspection and musical abandon" - a balance between precision and emotional risk that defines her work both on stage and behind it.

She has performed at the Salle Cortot in Paris, the Collège d'Espagne at the Cité Internationale Universitaire de Paris, the Sony Auditorium in Madrid, Carnegie Hall in New York, among others. Her work has also reached wider audiences through appearances on Spanish television and radio.

In 2013, alongside flutist Guillermo Laporta, she co-founded CreArtBox, a New York-based chamber music ensemble that fuses live performance with visual art, projection, and theatrical staging. Over the past decade, she has led its artistic direction - designing programs, commissioning new work, and building collaborations with composers and visual artists.

Since 2021, together with Laporta, she has co-directed Festival ADAR, a traveling arts festival in rural Asturias that weaves classical concerts, commissioned works, artist talks, and site-specific installations into the landscape of small villages.

Emilie-Anne Gendron VIOLIN

Violinist Emilie-Anne Gendron, lauded by the *New York Times* as a "brilliant soloist" and by *Strad Magazine* for her "marvelous and lyrical playing," enjoys a dynamic career based in New York City. A deeply committed chamber musician, Ms. Gendron is a longtime member of the Momena Quartet, currently quartet-in-residence at Binghamton University, and whose vision encompasses contemporary music of all backgrounds alongside great music from the past. She is a member and one of the concertmasters of the acclaimed Orpheus Chamber Orchestra and also collaborates with groups such as A Far Cry, Argento Chamber Ensemble, Chamber Music Society of Lincoln Center, Chamber Orchestra of Philadelphia, CreArtBox, INTERWOVEN, Iris Collective, Marlboro Music Festival / Musicians From Marlboro, New Asia Chamber Music Society, Orchestra of St. Luke's, Talea Ensemble, The Knights, and Sejong.

Ms. Gendron holds the distinction of being the first person in Juilliard's history to be accepted simultaneously to its two most selective courses of study, both the Doctor of Musical Arts and the Artist Diploma. She holds a B.A. in Classics and Ancient Studies from Columbia University.

Ms. Gendron plays on a 1673 Jacob Stainer violin on generous loan from the Englewood Chamber Players.

Matthew Cohen VIOLA

Ukrainian-American violist Matthew Cohen is a dynamic and versatile artist whose captivating performances have made him one of the most sought-after violists of his generation. Recently appointed as the violist of the Formosa Quartet and a founding member of Ensemble Elatós, he was a special prize winner at the prestigious Primrose International Viola Competition as well as garnering top prizes at the Citta di Cremona International Viola Competition in Italy, Vivo International Music Competition and the Art of Duo International Competition. Particularly interested in advocating for the viola as a unique voice, he is challenging the misconception that the viola has a limited repertoire by bringing attention to lesser-known gems as well as arrangements of other masterworks.

As a graduate of the Juilliard School's Master of Music program, he was the proud recipient of a Kovner Fellowship; he earned his Bachelor of Music degree from Cleveland Institute of Music and received an Artist Diploma from Colburn Conservatory where he studied with Misha Amory, Heidi Castleman, Paul Coletti, Jeffrey Irvine, and Cynthia Phelps.

Julia Yang CELLO

Praised for "her sense of joyful virtuosity" as concerto soloist (*South Florida Classical Review*), Julia Yang is a courageous and soulful cellist, multi-faceted performer, and founding member of the "riveting" (*Reading Eagle*) and "impeccably elegant" Merz Trio (*All About the Arts*) and freshly minted clarinet-cello-piano ensemble, Trio Phōs.

On stage, Yang has been described as the "stunning find of the evening" (*New York Classical Review*) and has been noted for her "dark, voluminous tone" and "utterly compelling" performances (*South Florida Classical Review*).

Yang's Merz Trio are first prize winners of the prestigious Naumburg Chamber Music Prize as well as of the Concert Artists Guild, Fischhoff and Chesapeake International Chamber Music competitions. The Trio presents innovative multidisciplinary concert experiences that interweave repertoire of the traditional piano trio genre with diverse art forms ranging from the visual arts, literature and dance to theatre and the culinary arts.

Yang has collaborated in chamber music with numerous artists including Jonathan Biss, Mitsuko Uchida, and Kim Kashkashian at festivals such as the Marlboro Music Festival, Lake Champlain Chamber Music Festival, Yellow Barn, The Valley of the Moon Festival, At the World's Edge Festival, Tippet Rise and Poland's Krzyszowa-Music.



The ensemble at The DiMenna Center, December 2025.

ABOUT CREARTBOX

Chamber music you can see

CreArtBox is a New York-based chamber music and multimedia ensemble founded in 2013, led by flutist Guillermo Laporta and pianist Josefina Urraca. The ensemble crafts immersive performances that merge classical and contemporary music with original visual art, stage design, and spatial storytelling.

Recognized by *The New Yorker* as one of its "art and music top picks" and praised by *Time Out* as "an ensemble devoted to multidisciplinary events", CreArtBox presents approximately six productions a year at The DiMenna Center, tours nationally, and performs internationally in Japan, Spain and the United Kingdom.

In parallel, the ensemble co-produces Festival ADAR each August in rural Asturias, Spain, pairing chamber music with site-specific performance in churches, hórreos and mountain villages.



At The DiMenna Center, December 2024.

Six productions a year at The DiMenna Center

creartbox.nyc

SUPPORT

World-class chamber music, open to everyone

CreArtBox was built on a commitment to accessibility: world-class chamber music should be available to everyone, regardless of their ability to pay.

Donor support lets us offer subsidized tickets through NYC Culture Pass and partnerships with the Queens Public Library, so cost is never a barrier. Ticket revenue alone does not cover the cost of producing performances, commissioning new works, or bringing music into schools.



EVERY GIFT MAKES A DIRECT IMPACT

Whether \$10 or \$1,000, it means a student attends their first live concert, a composer receives support to create new work, and we keep building a more inclusive chamber music community.

Your contribution helps us

- 01 Expand subsidized and free ticket programs
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- 03 Bring music into schools, libraries and community spaces across New York
- 04 Continue producing interdisciplinary programming



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GYÖRGY LIGETI

Musica Ricercata

Eleven movements, arranged
by Guillermo Laporta



CAROLINE SHAW

Thousandth Orange

Violin, viola, cello and piano



BRAHMS

Piano Quartet No. 3

III. Andante, at The
DiMenna Center

Also in the catalogue: Dvořák, *American Quartet* · Messiaen, *Quartet for the End of Time* · Mussorgsky, *Pictures at an Exhibition* · Vivaldi, *La Notte* · Hannah Selin, *Chesapeake* · Andrea Casarrubios, *Afilador*

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The rest of the season

Three more productions at The DiMenna Center.

Dec 11 2026	Winterlight Selin · Ravel · Caplan · Stravinsky
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Apr 23 2027	Pressure and Release Seven premieres from the Call for Scores
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May 7 2027	Feverdream de Somogyi · á Lavamúrurin · Sibelius
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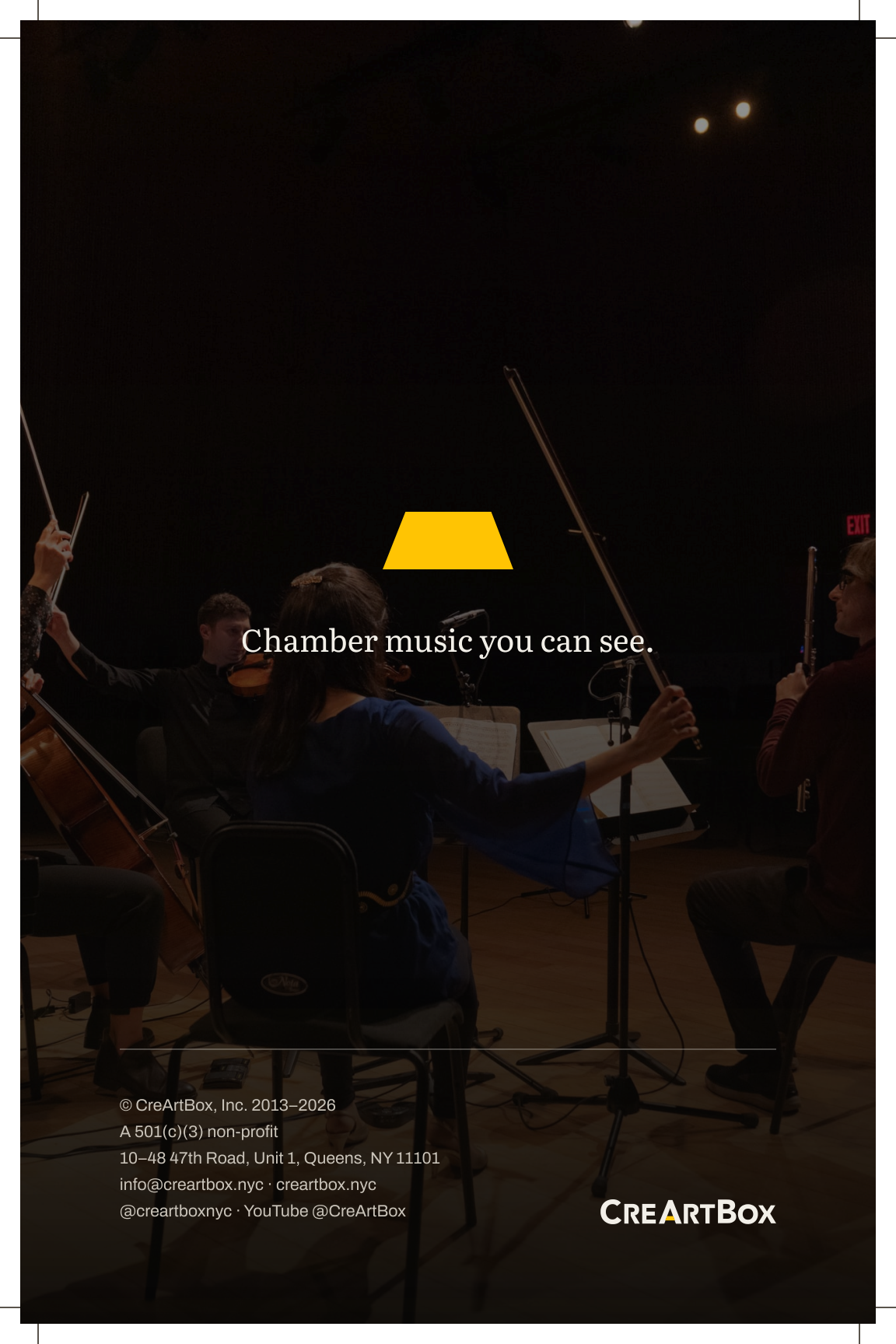
ON TOUR AND BEYOND

Nov 6	Engelbach-Hart Music Festival	Illinois
Dec 12	Queens Mother Goose	Queens Library
Feb 28	Chamber Music Society of Louisville	Kentucky
Apr 18	Masked Sounds	Saugerties, NY
Aug 2–15	Festival ADAR · 7th edition	Asturias

FULL CALENDAR

creartbox.nyc/concerts





Chamber music you can see.

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